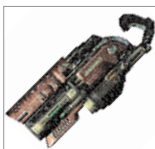


Quake Goes Real Life

Probably *Quake* enthusiasts themselves, the US Navy has developed the first working railgun, capable of damage equivalent to a Tomahawk cruise missile—without even using an explosive projectile! Write in and tell us which *Quake* weapon you think is next!



Microsoft Uses Comics To Fight Piracy

In a bid to reach a broader audience with their anti-piracy campaign, M-Dollar will now use comics to get their message across. The newspaper-style affairs will tell Little Johnny that piracy is bad, and hopes it will work better than the “give us money” argument.



Escape

WII CAUSES FIRST DEATH

Fata1ity!

First, there were the weak straps that snapped and turned gamers' Wiimotes into life- and gadget-threatening projectiles. Then there were the “Wii elbows” and other miscellaneous activity-related injuries, caused due to gamers' actually getting off their behinds to play games on the diminutive console. Now, the Wii turns deadly, claiming its first innocent victim—28-year old mother of three Jennifer Strange—and all she wanted was a Wii for her kids.

It all started when KDND 107.9 FM—a Sacramento, California radio station—decided to hold a “Hold your wee for a Wii” competition. Contestants had to drink a half-pint bottle of water every 15 minutes for the first hour, followed by larger ones. The winner was the last one to answer Nature's call (or scream), and was to

go home with considerably less wee and lots more Wii. At the end of the ordeal, Strange was apparently complaining of a severe headache and was almost in tears. Her body was subsequently found at her home, and the coroner's office pegged water intoxication as the cause. Your kidneys can only process 1 to 1.5 litres of water per hour, and consuming large volumes of the stuff lowers the sodium concentration in the blood, upsetting the balance between the fluids inside and outside blood cells. Water gets into blood cells through osmosis, causing them to swell and eventually rupture.

For once, though, Nintendo is well out of the controversy, and the blame goes squarely on the shoulders of the radio station. A prize as coveted

as the Wii was bound to cause disruptions in human sanity, as seen in the nitwits who actually put their health at risk for one. What, we ask again, is this world coming to?

LAND AHOY!

ThePirate Nation?

Swedish...ahem... “intellectual property reform group” The Pirate Bay has decided that it has faced too much oppression from the world, and plans to move to another country—preferably their own—where copyright laws are non-existent and the pirate community can carry on without a care in the world. The Principality of Sealand—a WWII naval platform off southern England—is up for sale, and Sweden's scurvy scallywags hope to snap it up, assuming their faithful

Whatever Happened To... Khoj.com

The Great Indian Search Engine, it's been touted as. At a time when the best we had was Altavista, Khoj.com appealed to us in that it was one of those few Indian Web sites you could go to and actually put it to some good use. It indexed all Great Indian Web Sites—in a still-Americanised Web, this was essential if you wanted to find anything related to India (there was no “Pages from India” search available back then). Today, though, Khoj is but a fond memory.

What happened? The same thing that happened to so many other search engines when Google conquered All—Indian sites or not, why would you even bother going anywhere else for your search results? Every search engine has had to rejig itself to match up, but the Big Three—Google, Yahoo and Live—are all that people care about these days. So we headed over to Khoj (which we hadn't visited since about 1999), to see what the Great Old Indian is up to.

It's been taken over by Sify (we don't know when that happened, not having visited in so long), but seemingly in shape. The design goes awry in Opera, but we're used to sites that don't follow Web standards. Type in a search for a Great Indian Web Site (Thinkdigit) and *voila!* A blank result. Turns out that the Khoj search—the default choice, by the way—is dead. The WWW search is fine, though hardly something you're going to prefer over Google. What happened is a big online mystery—Did Khoj's spiders get squished? Or were they retired? Does anyone even care?

Win! My Desktop

No winners this month!

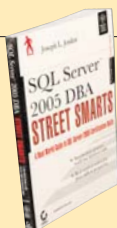
There were repeats of old ideas, but none that stood out the way the past few did. Try again!

Participate in this contest and win next month

Street Smart

by Joseph L Jorden
Published by

 WILEY-INDIA



Send in your Desktop with a description of how you made it to mydesktop@thinkdigit.com with the subject “My Desktop”, and tell us your postal address, too.